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Scenario 4
https://www.forbes.com/sites/daveywinder/2020/03/22/healthcare-workers-targeted-by-dangerous-new-windows-ransomware-campaign-using-coronavirus-as-bait/#2e05068a2212
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Wary of Netwalker Attacks

When many think of hackers, it is a common image of people getting into bank accounts and stealing money or breaking into personnel/proprietary data and blackmailing an individual.

Netwalker works a little differently, instead of taking personnel/proprietary data it locks it in place; with encryption.

An analogy:
- the bad actors are NOT going to your house and stealing your clothing
- bad actors ARE putting a lock on your closet so you cannot get to your own clothing. Then they are forcing you to pay them to get the key to lock.

Why do bad actors use Netwalker attacks?
- Netwalker does not need a constant connection or a lot of bandwidth
- The simplicity of if allows it to bypass computer security
- Computers use many encryptions to protect files and connections, so it is difficult for a computer to recognize this specific encryption as bad.

How do Netwalker attacks get in?
- Work from home (WFH) plays a role
    - A lot of data is stored on issued computers
    - It is easier to impersonate emails between people who do not see each other
        - e.g. dave@moon.com vs dave@rnoon.com (this is r n instead of m)
    - IT training is not moving as fast as people are transitioning to WFH
- People are seeking information and worried about COVID leading some to make poor decision in haste
- Companies are collecting a lot of sensitive data to try to understand COVID creating more people and points of entry for bad actors
- There are many other scenarios that create opportunities for Netwalker accounts but here have been upticks since the hit of COVID

How do the bad actors succeed?
- Extortion: They get paid (ransome) to decrypt the data
- They may get access to data when they are supposed to be decrypting it + ransom
- They get access to your banking information from the ransom + ransom

Who is susceptible?

- Everyone
- Government agencies, and Research and Medical facilities are more susceptible as they often have more proprietary/private data that they need to access, and the money and incentives to pay ransoms.

How can this affect the victims?

- Loss important personal information (e.g. photos, child's growth records, saved games)
- Loss important work files (e.g. spreadsheets, anecdotal reports, graphs, photos)
- Loss trust of clients, consenters, and participants; making future studies near impossible
- Loss of career or job
- Loss of time and mental stability
- Loss of money; as ransom or as money stolen while attempting to pay ransom
- Having the knowledge of paying a bad actor and them winning

What can be done to prevent attacks?

- Opening emails from trusted sources
- Only downloading software from trusted sources
- Keep backup of data in separate storage (e.g. cloud, NAS, work server)
    - This way a netwalker does encrypt a computer; it can just be wiped, and data can still be accessed.
- Work with IT to ensure your computer is up to date and ensure an understanding of threats.
- If a victim is a Netwalker attack, calm down, and seek help. It is easy to make the situation worse, and hard to make it better.
- Employees need to use company computers to access company servers, and company computers need to only be used for work
- Companies need to issue computers and other cloud devices to ensure employees only use those to access company resources
- Companies should have an internal email network, so employees know when they get an email from those outside the company